

microGPT – Detailed Mathematical Reference

Token Embedding

Tokens are converted into vectors via an embedding matrix E .
 $e_i = E[\text{token}_i]$

Interpretation: Each token selects one row from E .
No multiplication needed — this is a lookup operation.

Positional Encoding

Since Transformers lack recurrence, positional information is added:
 $x_i = e_i + p_i$

where p_i is the positional embedding.
This preserves dimensionality while injecting order.

Scaled Dot-Product Attention (Derivation)

Step 1: Compute similarity scores
 $\text{score} = QK^T$

Step 2: Scale to prevent large gradients
 $\text{score_scaled} = (QK^T) / \sqrt{d_k}$

Step 3: Normalize via softmax
 $A = \text{softmax}(\text{score_scaled})$

Step 4: Weighted sum of values
 $\text{Attention} = A V$

Softmax Function

Converts logits into probabilities:
 $\text{softmax}(z_i) = \exp(z_i) / \sum_j \exp(z_j)$

Ensures outputs sum to 1.

Layer Normalization (Derivation)

$\mu = \text{mean}(x)$
 $\sigma^2 = \text{variance}(x)$

$\text{LN}(x) = \gamma ((x - \mu) / \sqrt{(\sigma^2 + \epsilon)}) + \beta$

Normalizes per token, stabilizing training.

Feedforward Network

$$\text{FFN}(x) = \max(0, xW_1 + b_1) W_2 + b_2$$

Introduces nonlinearity and feature mixing.

Residual Connections

$$y = x + F(x)$$

Helps gradient flow in deep networks.

CrossEntropy Loss

$$L = - \sum y_i \log(p_i)$$

For correct class:

$$L = - \log(p_{\text{correct}})$$

Penalizes confident wrong predictions.

Gradient Descent

$$\theta \leftarrow \theta - \eta \nabla L(\theta)$$

Updates parameters to minimize loss.

Conceptual Diagram – Attention Flow

Input Embeddings

Q, K, V Projections

Attention Output